DRILL 21

RAPID INTERVENTION (RIT)

NFPA 1001 Level 2 (JPR 5.3.3) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

DOWNED FIREFIGHTER PACKAGING & FAST / RIT BASICS

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Rescue / Engine | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear & SCBA

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | 2-Firefighter RIT Team & Downed Firefighter

🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter serving on an exterior standby or Rapid Intervention Team (RIT/FAST) must be able to locate a downed firefighter in zero visibility, assess their air status, transfill high-pressure air via the **Universal Air Connection (UAC)**, convert their SCBA harness into a drag harness (or deploy the built-in **DRD - Drag Rescue Device**), and drag them to safety up or down stairs.

📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- RIT Pack (60-minute air cylinder, high-pressure UAC transfill hose, low-pressure EBSS hose, spare facepiece).
- 1 firefighter in full gear/SCBA acting as "Downed Firefighter" (or 180-lb mannequin).
- 20-ft length of 1-inch tubular webbing.
- Flash hoods reversed over facepieces to simulate zero visibility.

⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **Facepiece Seal Security:** When dragging a downed firefighter, watch that their facepiece is not pulled off by rubbing against floors or stairs.

⚠️ **High-Pressure Equalization:** When connecting the UAC transfill whip, listen for the rapid rush of equalizing air (can take 30–60 seconds to balance cylinders).

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: Shout "STOP!" immediately if the downed firefighter's airway or regulator hose is pinched or disconnected during dragging.**

PHASE 1: RAPID ASSESSMENT UPON REACHING DOWNED FIREFIGHTER (10 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. Team arrives at downed firefighter.
2. Turn off downed firefighter's PASS device to allow verbal communication.
3. **Air Assessment (The 3-Step Air Check):**
   - Feel for air exhausting from the regulator (is member breathing?).
   - Check remote pressure gauge (is cylinder empty?).
   - Confirm facepiece is seated firmly against face.

PHASE 2: HIGH-PRESSURE AIR TRANSFILL (UAC) (15 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

1. If the downed firefighter is breathing but low on air:
   - Deploy the high-pressure transfill whip from the RIT pack.
   - Locate the **Universal Air Connection (UAC)** port on the downed firefighter's SCBA harness (located within 4 inches of the main cylinder valve).
   - Pop the rubber dust cap off the UAC port.
   - Push the transfill female coupling straight onto the UAC male nipple until it clicks and locks into place.
   - High-pressure air immediately transfers and equalizes between the RIT cylinder and the downed firefighter's cylinder.
   - Do not disconnect until pressure equalizes (gauge reads balanced).

PHASE 3: PACKAGING & THE SCBA HARNESS CONVERSION (20 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. **The Harness Leg-Loop Conversion:**
   - Downed firefighters slide out of their SCBA harness if dragged by the shoulder straps!
   - Unbuckle the waist belt.
   - Pull the waist belt buckle down between the downed firefighter's legs.
   - Re-buckle the waist strap around the groin/thighs.
   - Result: The SCBA harness is now a full-body climbing harness; pulling on the shoulder straps or cylinder will not pull the pack off their back!
2. **Deploying the DRD (Drag Rescue Device):**
   - Grasp the Velcro flap at the back of the bunker coat collar.
   - Pull the built-in webbing loop out until fully extended (creates a 2-foot drag handle around the firefighter's upper torso).
3. **Staircase Extrication (Head First):**
   - When dragging a downed firefighter up stairs, position rescuer facing backwards up the stairs.
   - Grasp the converted harness straps or DRD handle.
   - Rest the downed firefighter's head and neck on your boots/shins to prevent their skull from bouncing on stair treads.
   - Walk backward up the stairs using leg drive.

⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ❌ *Dragging without converting the harness:* Dragging a firefighter by their coat or unbuckled pack will slide the coat over their head and rip off their facepiece, exposing their airway to superheated gases!
- ❌ *Fumbling for the UAC port:* In zero visibility, feel for the cylinder handwheel; the UAC port is located right beside it. Practice finding it blindfolded.

🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"How long did it take to locate the UAC port blindfolded?", "Did the converted waist belt prevent the pack from sliding off?"***

✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- ☐ RIT pack cylinder refilled to 4,500 PSI; transfill hose wiped and re-bagged.
- ☐ Turnout coat DRD straps pushed back into collar flaps and velcroed flat.
- ☐ SCBA harness straps untangled and restored to normal donning position.
- ☐ Attendance roster signed.

DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE	SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE	DATE COMPLETED	TRAINING HOURS